

Massive AI Data Centers Are Bringing Economic Booms to Counties Across America

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AP Photo/Jenny Kane

Massive 500-megawatt data centers are bringing significant **economic** gains to communities across the United States, directly solving many of the economic concerns plaguing average Americans.

According to a Wells Fargo Securities study, since 2024, counties hosting these large-scale data centers have seen increased housing stock, rising home values, greater job creation, and lower unemployment when compared to the national average.

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Counties that build data centers are seeing new housing, higher home values, lower unemployment and more job growth...



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Since 2024, counties hosting large data centers have posted major gains across the board. Home values have climbed nearly 15 percent, well ahead of the national average of just under 10 percent. Even in counties where facilities remain under construction, home prices have risen roughly 7 percent.

The employment gains are even more striking. National job growth sits at just over one percent, but counties with data

centers under construction have seen growth closer to two percent. Where massive 500-megawatt centers are already operating, job growth has reached roughly four percent, nearly four times the national rate.

Housing growth has also surged in communities with operational data centers. While the national housing-growth rate remains negative amid a broader supply shortage, housing stock in counties with active facilities has risen by nearly 50 percent. Counties with data centers still under construction have seen housing construction fall by about 10 percent, likely reflecting a short-term demand shock as workers arrive before supply catches up. Many developers, however, are investing directly in local housing to help close that gap.

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The unemployment data also reinforces the consistent trend of economic gains. The national rate sits just above 4.2 percent, compared with approximately 3.9 percent in counties with facilities under construction and just 3.5 percent in counties with operational data centers.

The chart may not map perfectly onto the effects of every data center, particularly those smaller than 500 megawatts. But it does show the broader economic trend: data centers are associated with economic growth, not deprivation, in the

communities that host them.

Individual cases also reinforce the point. For example, in Ellendale, North Dakota, a **400-megawatt data center** has generated roughly nine times the town's typical annual sales-tax revenue this year, helped expand the local housing stock, and brought new economic activity to a 1,100 person community that had long been overlooked.

Broader economic concerns tend to focus on the long term, especially jobs, since construction can produce only a temporary employment boost. But these massive projects in particular create several hundred permanent positions, and the data points in the same direction. As the Wells Fargo study shows, job growth in communities with operational data centers actually outpaces growth in communities where the facilities are still under construction.

Other concerns center on utility costs, particularly electricity. But **the available research** shows that, in communities with data centers, electricity prices either decline or rise in line with inflation.

Data centers remain deeply unpopular with much of the American public as well: over half of Americans are wary of their construction, and Democrats and Republicans alike have begun **imposing moratoriums** and additional approval barriers on new projects.

This lack of faith reflects a broader turn against the free market. Too many Americans appear willing to impose government control on an emerging technology in hopes of quelling fears that are often unsupported by the data.

History lands squarely on the side of innovation. The sooner

the United States recognizes that, the sooner Americans can share in the economic boom that artificial intelligence, and its accompanying data centers, can bring.



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anon-g6jp

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Cha-Ching, Dimitri! You must be racking it up for you data center promotions.

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People like you are exactly why articles on this topic are so important.

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Electric rates will go up and their water usage for cooling their devices will raise water rates as well. There are no good things for the average person.

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i've yet to see any reporting on the types of permanent jobs data centers offer.

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BP

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a month ago

It's been said that we have to beat China in the AI race. What does that mean exactly? Are there to be huge data centers in each town or county in America? If they're so all powerful, why do we need hundreds if not thousands of them? I'm not trying to be snarky, I just really want to know where this is heading and is there an end.

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anon-vz2n

a month ago

This is a propaganda piece. It sickens me. Will we sell our collective soul for an economic boom? It remains to be seen whether AI is a net positive for our civilization. The direction though is clear. It places a lot of unaccountable power in the hands of a technology which even its creators don't fully understand. Someone asked Musk how far away we are from Skynet. He said 5 years and he was not joking around. The potential for evil in these massive data stores is huge. They will store every movement, every conversation and every purchase of every individual worldwide. If that doesn't frighten you, then you have no soul. Musk said the only way to prevent the loss of freedom is to have an AI to fight AI, controlled, of course, by him. God help us. Correction. We have already rejected God. We have no right to ask.

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anon-s1v6

 anon-vz2n

a month ago

Don't be late to the party. This is the new Industrial Revolution.

1 2 Reply 

AN

anon-z82k

 anon-vz2n

a month ago edited

Its obvious you don't even know what an economy is, or what it does.

Are you familiar with free markets? Perhaps with how it benefited all levels of humanity, from alleviating poverty, to reducing how much people have to work to be productive, to all the goodies you now rely on everyday and couldn't live without? How about the average life expectancy of infants, general humanity, the increased quality of food, the increasing lack of starvation across the world, and the abundance of things that once called luxuries are now practically needs. How is AI not the same?

How is it not the same?

Why does everyone suddenly become a luddite when the conversation switches to AI?

2 2 Reply



anon-vz2n anon-z82k
a month ago

Why? Because of the threat that the technology represents to freedom. Massive data farms all over the country, cataloguing that can be catalogued is NOT compatible with a free society. This is so obvious that AI advocates must have been blinded, by greed, by lust for power, by worship at the alter of new technology. The dangers far outweigh the possible benefits. I am a physicist. I love technology but I know enough to know that humanity cannot be trusted with such power. I am also astute enough to know that the AI juggernaut cannot be stopped. This is the way the world ends. Not with a bang but a whimper. You will get your way. You are welcome to it.

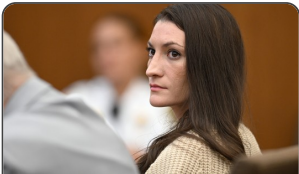
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Commodore Decker
a month ago edited

Yeah, so that means New York probably won't do it. The natural gas boom has passed us by, the nuclear energy revival is going in the wrong direction and now the data centers are too. Before, it was AOC

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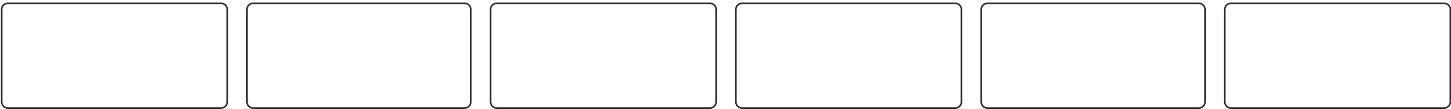
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